

COMPLETE DESIGN REDESIGN

FLARQ 2.0

A futuristic design system for an AI-powered job search operating system. Dark-first, ambient, alive.

Google Cloud Rapid Agent Hackathon

Prepared by Z.ai · May 2026

Design Philosophy & Color System

FLARQ is not a SaaS dashboard. It is an AI operating system. The design must feel like a command center, not a spreadsheet. Dark-first, ambient, and alive.

Three Design Principles

- 1

Dark Command Center
Dark mode is the default. Deep space blacks with luminous accents create focus and reduce eye strain during long job search sessions. Light mode exists but dark is identity.
- 2

Ambient Intelligence
The UI breathes. The Flarq Orb pulses gently, backgrounds shift with context, and micro-animations signal that the AI is always thinking. The product never feels static.
- 3

Neural Aesthetics
Gradients flow like synapses. Tool executions appear as glowing nodes on a graph. The design language borrows from neural network visualizations, not corporate dashboards.

COLOR PALETTE

The “Nebula” Palette

Void
#07080a

Surface
#0f1117

Card
#161821

Border
#1e2030

Muted
#6b7094

Primary
#7c5cfc → #38bdf8

Indigo
#7c5cfc

Amber
#f5a623

Emerald
#34d399

Rose
#f472b6

Why This Palette Wins

Indigo → **Sky gradient** is the primary identity. It evokes neural networks, deep space, and AI-native products. Unlike the old teal (#0d9488) which reads as "healthcare" or "finance," indigo reads as "intelligence."

Amber is the CTA color. It creates warmth and urgency against the cool dark background. "Start for free" and "Analyze" buttons in amber pop like a beacon.

Emerald signals success (match scores, offers, completed). **Rose** signals gaps, alerts, and missing skills. Together they create a semantic color language that is instantly scannable.

```
// tailwind.config.ts - Complete color system
colors: {
```

```
void:      '#07080a',
surface:   '#0f1117',
card:      '#161821',
border:    '#1e2030',
muted:     '#6b7094',
text:      '#e4e6ef',
primary:   { DEFAULT: '#7c5cfc', light: '#9d85fd' },
amber:     '#f5a623',
emerald:   '#34d399',
rose:      '#f472b6',
sky:       '#38bdf8',
}
```

Typography & Gradient System

Space Grotesk for headings (geometric, technical), Inter for body (humanist, readable), JetBrains Mono for code and data. Three families, clear hierarchy.

Display / H1 – Space Grotesk 700, 32px

Your AI Career Operating System

H2 – Space Grotesk 600, 22px

Gap Analysis Complete

H3 – Space Grotesk 600, 16px

Matching Skills

Body – Inter 400, 14px, line-height 1.65

Flarq analyzed your resume against 12 requirements. You match 8 skills and have gaps in 4 areas. Generate a tailored cover letter to bridge the difference.

Code/Data – JetBrains Mono 500, 13px

match_score: 0.87

Font Loading

```
@import url('https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2'+SpaceGrotesk:wght@500;600;700'+Inter:wght@300;400;500;600;700'+JetBrainsMono:wght@400;500;600'&display=swap');

/* Tailwind config */
fontFamily: {
  display: ['Space Grotesk', 'sans-serif'],
  body:    ['Inter', 'sans-serif'],
  mono:    ['JetBrains Mono', 'monospace'],
}
```

Why Space Grotesk Over Plus Jakarta Sans

Plus Jakarta Sans is a beautiful humanist sans, but it reads as "friendly startup." Space Grotesk has geometric precision and a technical edge that says "operating system." The subtle squareness of its letterforms (especially G, Q, R) evokes engineering blueprints and terminal interfaces. For an AI agent product, this is the correct personality.

GRADIENT SYSTEM

Four Gradient Presets



Neural
primary → sky



Aurora
primary → rose



Sunset
amber → rose



Horizon
emerald → sky

```
// CSS gradient utilities
.grad-neural { background: linear-gradient(135deg, #7c5cfc, #38bdf8); }
.grad-aurora { background: linear-gradient(135deg, #7c5cfc, #f472b6); }
.grad-sunset { background: linear-gradient(135deg, #f5a623, #f472b6); }
.grad-horizon { background: linear-gradient(135deg, #34d399, #38bdf8); }

// Text gradient utility
.text-gradient {
  background-clip: text;
  -webkit-background-clip: text;
```

```
-webkit-text-fill-color: transparent;  
}
```

Gradient Usage Rules

Neural (indigo → sky): Primary identity. Hero headings, the Flarq Orb, active nav items, primary buttons.

Aurora (indigo → rose): Premium moments. Cover letter generation, match score celebration.

Sunset (amber → rose): CTAs and urgency. "Start for free," "Analyze now," stale application alerts.

Horizon (emerald → sky): Success states. Offer stage, high match scores, completed actions.

Animation System

Animations in FLARQ 2.0 serve a purpose: they communicate state, guide attention, and create the feeling that the AI is alive. Nothing moves without reason.

1. The Flarq Orb

HERO ELEMENT

The Orb is the visual embodiment of the AI. It appears on the Agent page, landing page, and as a micro-icon in the navbar. It has three states:

Idle State

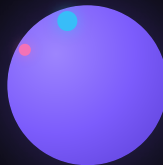
Gentle breathing pulse (scale 1.0 → 1.03, 4s ease-in-out). Three orbiting dots at different speeds (6s, 10s, 14s). Box-shadow pulses from 0.3 → 0.5 opacity.

Thinking State

Orbiting dots accelerate (2s, 3.5s, 5s). Orb glows brighter (shadow 0.5 → 0.8). Ring around orb rotates with a conic-gradient shimmer. Dots leave trailing afterimages.

Responding State

Orb returns to idle but a subtle ripple emanates outward (expanding ring, 2s, fade out). This signals that a response has been delivered.



Flarq Orb (idle state) — radial gradient core with 2 orbiting satellite dots

```
// Orb component (simplified)
const FlarqOrb = ({ state }) => (
  < div className="orb">

    < div className="orb-core" />

    {[6, 10, 14].map((s) => (
      < div
        key={s}
        className="orb-dot"
        style={{
          animationDuration:
            state === 'thinking'
              ? `${s/3}s`
              : `${s}s`
        }}
      />
    ))}

  </ div >
)
```

CORE ANIMATIONS

fadeUp

Elements enter from below with opacity 0 → 1 and y: 20 → 0. Duration 0.5s, ease-out. Used for page sections, cards, and list items. Stagger: 0.08s between siblings.

scaleIn

Match score ring, modals, and toast notifications scale from 0.9 → 1 with opacity. Spring physics: stiffness 260, damping 20. Creates a satisfying "pop" on arrival.

shimmer

Skeleton loaders use a horizontal gradient sweep (transparent → rgba(255,255,255,0.05) → transparent) that moves left to right over 2s. Replaces the old "pulse" skeleton.

drawIn

SVG stroke-dashoffset animation for the landing page NodeGraph and decorative icons. Lines draw from 0 to full length over 1.5s with ease-out. Creates a "blueprint being sketched" effect.

countUp

Dashboard stats animate from 0 to their value over 1.2s with ease-out. Uses useCountUp hook with requestAnimationFrame. Numbers tick up in a satisfying, precise way.

ripple

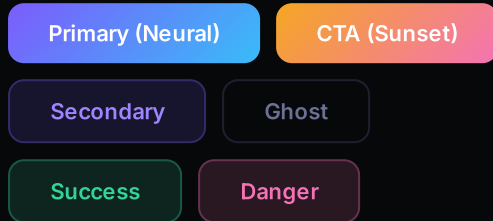
When the agent responds, a ring expands outward from the Orb (scale 1→2.5, opacity 0.6→0, 2s). Creates a "sonar ping" effect that signals the AI has finished thinking.

```
// framer-motion variants
const fadeUp = {
  initial: { opacity: 0, y: 20 },
  animate: { opacity: 1, y: 0,
    transition: { duration: 0.5, ease: "easeOut" } },
}
const stagger = {
  animate: { transition: { staggerChildren: 0.08 } },
}
const scaleIn = {
  initial: { scale: 0.9, opacity: 0 },
  animate: { scale: 1, opacity: 1,
    transition: { type: "spring", stiffness: 260, damping: 20 } },
}
```

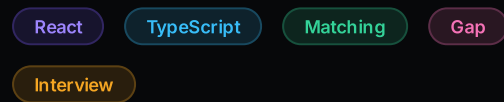
Component Design System

Every component in FLARQ 2.0 follows a consistent design language: dark surfaces, gradient borders, and ambient glow effects.

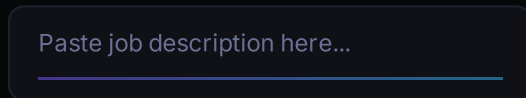
Button Variants



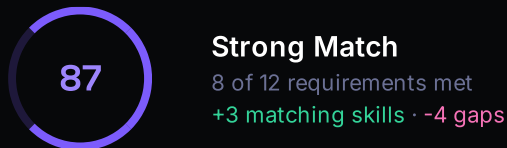
Badge/Tag Variants



Input Field



Match Score Ring



Glow Card Component

The signature card component. A subtle gradient border that glows on hover, creating depth without clutter. Used for feature cards, stat cards, and application cards.

```
// GlowCard.tsx
const GlowCard = ({ children, gradient }) => (
  < div className="relative group">
    < div className="absolute -inset-px rounded-xl
      opacity-40 group-hover:opacity-70
      transition-opacity duration-500"
      style={{ background: gradient }} />
    < div className="relative bg-card rounded-xl
      p-5 border border-border">
      {children}
    </ div >
  </ div >
)

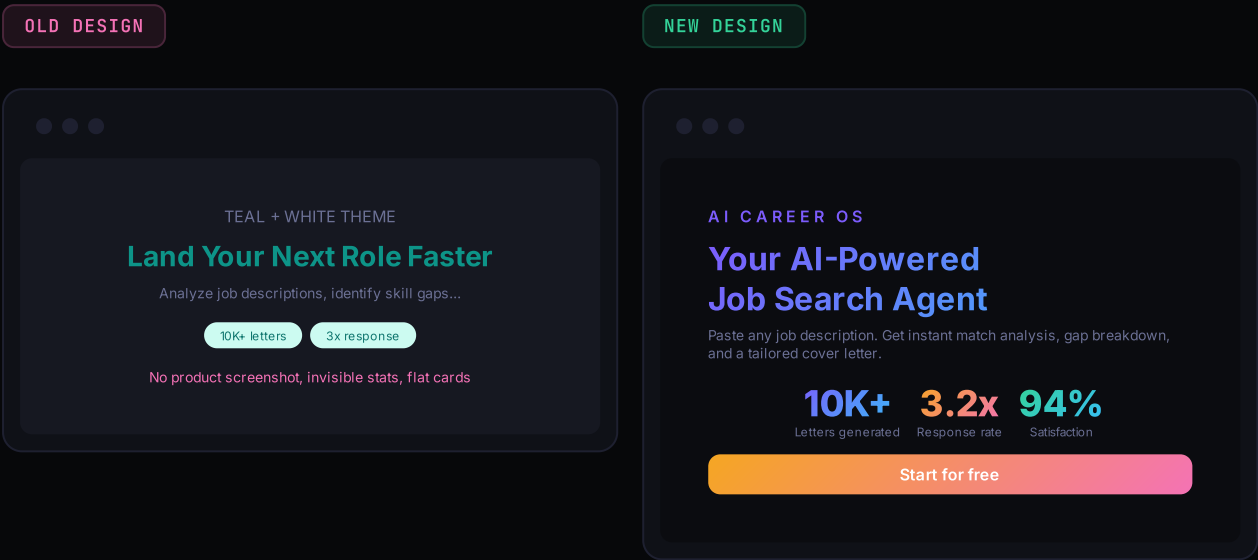
// Usage:
< GlowCard gradient="linear-gradient(135deg,
  #7c5cfc, #38bdf8)">
  {content}
</ GlowCard >
```

Status Indicators

● Applied ● Interview ● Offer ● Rejected

Landing Page Redesign

The landing page must stop a judge in their tracks. Dark, atmospheric, with a clear value proposition and a visible "aha moment."



Landing Page Structure (Top to Bottom)

- 1

Hero Section — Dark Background with Neural Particles
Full-width dark section with a canvas-based particle system (subtle dots connected by faint lines, drifting slowly). Large gradient headline. Amber CTA button. Three hero stats in gradient text. No NodeGraph SVG — replace with an animated product mockup showing the MatchScoreRing in action.
- 2

Social Proof Bar — Gradient Numbers
A single row of three metrics with large gradient numbers (text-5xl, font-extrabold, text-gradient). Each metric has a small label underneath. This replaces the old invisible 12px pills.
- 3

Feature Cards — GlowCards with Hover
Three GlowCards (gradient border on hover). Each card: icon (Lucide), title, 2-line description. Cards use the Neural gradient border. At rest they have a subtle 1px border — on hover the gradient border fades in with a glow effect.
- 4

"How It Works" — 4 Steps with Connected Dots
Four numbered circles connected by a horizontal gradient line. Each step: number, title, one-line description. The line draws in sequentially (stroke-dashoffset animation on scroll). Much more dynamic than the old static numbered circles.
- 5

Agent Preview — Live Demo Card
A dark card showing a simulated agent conversation. The Flarq Orb pulses in the corner. A user message and an AI response are visible. Tool execution chips glow. This gives judges an "aha moment" — they can see the product in action before signing up.
- 6

CTA Section — Sunset Gradient Button
Dark background. "Ready to land your next role?" in large Space Grotesk. Amber-to-rose gradient CTA button with hover glow (shadow expands from 0 to 20px). "No credit card required" in muted text below.

```
// Landing page particle background
import Particles from '@tsparticles/react'
```

```
const particleConfig = {
  particles: {
    number: { value: 40 },
    color: { value: ['#7c5cfc', '#38bdf8'] },
    opacity: { value: 0.15 },
    size: { value: { min: 1, max: 3 } },
    links: {
      enable: true,
      color: '#7c5cfc',
      opacity: 0.06,
      distance: 150,
    },
    move: { enable: true, speed: 0.5 },
  }
}
```

Auth, Dashboard & Profile Redesign

Auth Page

Visual: Split layout. Left half: dark surface with the Flarq Orb breathing in the center, tagline "Your AI career strategist" in gradient text. Right half: auth form on a slightly lighter card surface.

Key changes:

- Google OAuth button (mandatory for a Google Cloud product)
- "Forgot password?" link below the password field
- Password strength indicator (colored bar: rose → amber → emerald)
- The animated tab indicator (layoutId) stays — it was already great
- Form inputs have gradient bottom borders instead of plain borders

Dashboard Page

Visual: Dark command center feel. Time-based greeting with user's first name in gradient text ("Good morning, Sarah").

Key changes:

- Stat cards use GlowCard with gradient borders (Neural, Sunset, Horizon, Aurora — one per card)
- Each stat has a trend indicator (arrow + percentage change)
- Add a sparkline chart in each stat card (tiny AreaChart, 7 data points)
- Quick action cards have unique subtitles and matching gradient icons
- Recent applications section with hover-expand rows
- Stale applications banner uses rose gradient with pulsing dot

Profile Page

Visual: Full-width dark page with a profile header card at the top.

Key changes:

- Profile avatar: Circle with user's initials on a Neural gradient background (replaces plain letter in navbar)
- Profile completeness bar: Animated progress with Horizon gradient fill, percentage label
- Skills section: Inline tag input with autocomplete. Type to add, click X to remove (the remove button now works!). Tags use the 5-color system (purple=technical, sky=framework, emerald=matching, rose=gap, amber=tool)
- Experience timeline: Each entry is a GlowCard with a left border accent (3px gradient line)
- Resume upload: Drop zone with dashed border that transitions to a solid gradient border on drag-over. Animated upload progress with a shimmer effect
- Manual edit mode: Slide-in panel from the right instead of an inline card

Sidebar Navigation NEW

Replace the top Navbar (authenticated pages only) with a dark sidebar on the left. The sidebar contains: Flarq Orb logo at top, icon + label nav items, user avatar at bottom.

Why: Dashboard-heavy apps need persistent navigation. A sidebar is more scannable than a top bar, provides more vertical space for content, and creates a professional "app" feel. The sidebar is 64px wide (icons only) by default, expanding to 240px on hover or on wider screens.

Analyze, Applications & Analytics

Analyze Page — The Star Feature

This is already the best page. The redesign amplifies its strengths and fixes the remaining weaknesses.

1

JD Input: Gradient-bordered textarea with line count

The textarea has a gradient bottom border (Neural). As the user types, a small counter shows character count and estimated read time. On focus, the border glows brighter. Placeholder text: "Paste a job description and watch Flarq analyze your match..."

2

Match Score Ring: Aurora gradient for high scores

The ring uses conditional gradients: Horizon (emerald → sky) for scores 80+, Neural (indigo → sky) for 60-79, Sunset (amber → rose) for below 60. The ring animates with a conic-gradient sweep on load (like a gauge filling up). The number counts up from 0 to the final score.

3

Skill Tags: Color-coded with stagger animation

Matching skills = emerald tags, gap skills = rose tags. Tags cascade in with stagger:0.05s fadeUp animation. Each gap skill has a subtle "bridge" icon suggesting it can be addressed in the cover letter.

4

Cover Letter: Markdown-rendered with gradient accent

The cover letter is rendered with react-markdown for proper formatting. Left border is a 3px Neural gradient. Tone selector uses the Button component (not raw buttons). "Copy" button uses amber CTA variant. "Regenerate" uses ghost variant with a rotation animation on the icon.

Applications — Kanban Board

Column headers use the new color system: Applied (indigo), Screening (sky), Interview (amber), Offer (emerald), Rejected (rose). Each column has a colored top border (3px) and a count badge.

Application cards are GlowCards with company name, role, match score mini-ring, and tags. Actions are always visible (not hidden on hover). Delete uses a proper Modal, not window.confirm().

Drag overlay: When dragging, the card lifts with a glow shadow and slight scale (1.02). The drop zone shows a dashed gradient border.

APPLIED (3)

Google
Senior Engineer

Stripe
Staff Dev

INTERVIEW (1)

Vercel
Frontend Lead

OFFER (1)

Figma
Principal Eng

Analytics Page

Funnel visualization is rebuilt with Framer Motion animated bars (not raw SVG). Each stage is a horizontal bar with rounded corners that animates from width:0 to its proportional width. Stage labels are inside the bars. Colors progress from indigo (applied) through amber (interview) to emerald (offer).

Recharts charts use the new palette: area fills use Neural gradient (indigo → sky at 20% opacity). Bar charts use emerald for "have" skills and rose for "missing" skills. Grid lines are dashed at 0.5px in border color. Axis labels are 11px in muted color.

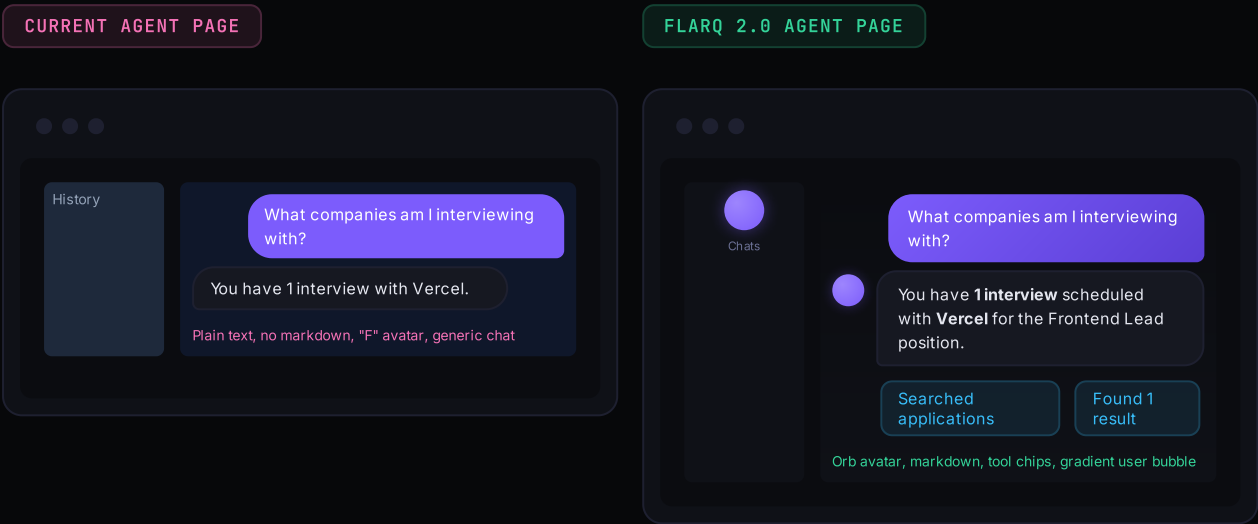
"Powered by MongoDB aggregations" is removed — this is developer copy. Replace with a subtle "Data from your applications" label.

Date range selector is added: a dropdown with "Last 7 days", "Last 30 days", "Last 90 days", "All time". Default: "Last 30 days".

Stale applications section uses a rose

Agent Page — The Hero Differentiator

This is the page that wins or loses the competition. It must feel like nothing the judges have seen before — not a chatbot, but an AI command center.



Agent Page — Complete Redesign Blueprint

- 1 Layout: Full-Height Dark Canvas**

No PageWrapper, no Navbar. The entire viewport is a dark canvas (bg-void #07080a). A floating sidebar on the left (240px) shows conversation history. The Flarq Orb sits at the top of the sidebar, always visible, always breathing. The sidebar background is slightly lighter (bg-surface) with a gradient right border.
- 2 The Orb: Always Present, Always Alive**

The Flarq Orb (64px) sits in the top-left of the sidebar. In idle state, it breathes with a gentle pulse. When the user sends a message, it transitions to "thinking" state — orbiting dots accelerate, glow intensifies, a conic-gradient ring spins around it. When the response arrives, a ripple emanates outward. The Orb NEVER disappears. It is the visual anchor of the entire page.
- 3 User Messages: Gradient Bubbles**

User messages use a Neural gradient background (indigo → sky, darker variant) with white text. They appear on the right side with rounded corners (bottom-right: 4px). This creates a strong visual distinction from the old flat teal bubbles.
- 4 Agent Messages: Markdown + Ambient Glow**

Agent messages are rendered with react-markdown (supports bold, lists, code blocks, headers). Each message has a subtle ambient glow behind it (absolute inset -8px, bg-primary/5, blur-xl). The Flarq Orb avatar (24px mini version) appears to the left of each message. Messages enter with fadeUp animation, staggered 0.03s per message.
- 5 Tool Execution: Live Node Graph**

When the agent calls a tool, a chip appears inline with a glowing icon and label ("Searched 12 applications", "Ran analytics pipeline"). On hover, the chip expands to show a mini card with the tool result preview. The chips use semantic colors: sky for search, amber for analytics, emerald for profile, rose for alerts. This is the "neural aesthetics" principle in action.

Input Bar: Floating with Glow

The input bar is fixed at the bottom, centered (max-width 720px). It has a gradient border (Neural) that glows on focus. The send button is a circle with the Neural gradient that glows on hover (box-shadow expands from 0 to 20px). Suggestion chips appear above the input as small, clickable pills with ghost styling. The typing indicator is replaced by the Orb's "thinking" state animation.

Agent Page Code & Implementation Guide

```
// AgentPage.tsx - Core structure
export default function AgentPage() {
  return (
    < div className="flex h-screen bg-void">
      {/* Sidebar */}
      < aside className="w-60 bg-surface border-r
        border-border/50 flex flex-col">
        < div className="p-4 flex items-center gap-3">
          < FlarqOrb size=40 state={orbState} />
          < span className="font-display font-semibold
            text-gradient">FLARQ</ span >
        </ div >
        < ConversationList />
        < NewChatButton />
      </ aside >

      {/* Main chat area */}
      < main className="flex-1 flex flex-col
        bg-gradient-to-b from-void to-surface/50">
        < MessageList />
        < SuggestionChips />
        < InputBar />
      </ main >
    </ div >
  )
}
```

```
// MessageBubble.tsx - Agent message with ambient glow
const AssistantBubble = ({ message }) => (
  < motion.div
    initial={{ opacity: 0, y: 8 }}
    animate={{ opacity: 1, y: 0 }}
    className="flex gap-3 items-start"
  >
    < FlarqOrbMini />

    < div className="relative">
      {/* Ambient glow */}
      < div className="absolute -inset-2 rounded-2xl
        bg-primary/5 blur-xl" />
      < div className="relative rounded-2xl rounded-bl-sm
        border border-border bg-card px-4 py-3
        text-sm leading-relaxed text-text">
        < ReactMarkdown >{message.content}</ ReactMarkdown >
      </ div >
    </ div >

    {/* Tool chips */}
    {message.tool_calls?.map(tool => (
```

```

    < ToolChip key={tool.id} tool={tool} />
  )))
</ div >
</ motion.div >
)

```

SECTION 10

Light Mode & Implementation Priority

Light Mode (Secondary)

Dark mode is the identity, but light mode is required for accessibility. The light palette inverts the surfaces while keeping the accent colors identical:

Void → **White** (#ffffff) | **Surface** → #f8fadc | **Card** → #ffffff | **Border** → #e2e8f0 | **Text** → #0f172a | **Muted** → #64748b

The Orb, gradients, and accent colors remain the same. GlowCard borders use the same gradients but at 30% opacity (reduced from 40% in dark mode). The Agent page keeps its dark theme even in light mode — it is a "dark room" within the app.

Implementation Priority (What to Build First)

P0

Color system + Typography (2 hours)

Update tailwind.config.ts with new colors. Add Google Fonts. Create CSS gradient utilities. This is the foundation — everything else depends on it.

P0

GlowCard + Button + Badge components (2 hours)

Build the three most-reused components with the new design. Replace all existing card/button/badge usages. Delete the old teal-cta CSS class.

P1

Agent page redesign (4 hours)

Flarq Orb component, message bubbles with react-markdown, tool chips, ambient glow, gradient input bar. This is the competition differentiator.

P1

Landing page + favicon (3 hours)

New hero section with particle background, gradient stats, GlowCard features, agent preview card. Fix the favicon to use indigo instead of purple.

P2

Remaining pages + sidebar (4 hours)

Dashboard stat cards, Profile page fixes, Kanban column colors, Analytics animated funnel. Add the collapsible sidebar for authenticated pages.